



I'm zooming away thanks to the lens on my Nikon D40x

greenery and wildlife, including tiger, leopard and cheetal (spotted deer). The trip itself was fun, village roads, a lot of greenery and water bodies, and a small but scenic ghat section. I took a lot of photos all along the way including a few clicks of a family of monkeys that were sunning themselves along the road. Everything seems so green here, unfortunately after dark the mosquitoes become a problem—thanks to the repellent I brought along I was immune.

Kanha wildlife reserve proved to be the kind of holiday escapade I was looking for. I booked a small cottage, and immediately settled in. Thankfully two plug points meant all my gadgetry was in good charge. A couple of days of small treks skirting the reserve, (for safety reasons nobody is allowed on foot into the wildlife reserve), a lot of rest, and updating my log, and my photograph collection with various interesting tidbits, and I was ready for a foray into the park.

We set off early morning, and though I couldn't leave the vehicle I could get a lot of shots out of the window. There is always an armed person onboard each vehicle and this I got a nice photo of the guy with his rifle, proudly twirling his moustache. The winding road into the park was in permanent leaf shadow, giving the illusion of semi-darkness. About four kilometres into the park we chanced upon a bunch of grazing spotted deer, I got a few good shots, and quickly made a voice note on my cell phone. By now we were out of cell phone coverage area, and WiFi is non-existent in the region anyways. I felt different somehow, to be just a couple of hours of flight away from Mumbai, but yet so disconnected, so isolated from civilisation, if you'll pardon the dramatic way of putting it. My Suunto X9i showed the temperature at 33 degrees, and we were at an altitude of 320 metres. I was longing for a photo of some of the big cats, but the guide told me that winter (November to February) is the best time to come across the beasts and when it heats up they prefer dense foliage—only coming out at night for a drink of water or a hunt. Twice we came across families of monkeys, and the occasional birdcall was the only disturbance from the otherwise silent jungle.

We had a quick meal on the go (vehicles aren't allowed to stop) and another three hours later we were back this time by another route. My last evening was spent in front of a campfire, with one of the drivers, and a couple of security staff. Dinner consisted of chicken curry, puffy omelettes, and parathas, after which we talked well into the night. The following day I joined another group of tourists for another incursion into the park after which I left Kanha and boarded one of the many tourist buses back to Jabalpur. From there I would catch a bus to Nagpur, and then a flight back to Mumbai.

One week later...

It's been my second day at work now, and I don't know why I wasn't surprised when our editor came up and asked me for an account of my travails over a can of Diet Coke after work. I was surprised when he informed me that my diary was to become the subject matter of this article. He wanted to visualise it as the week spent by a geek away from traditional, Digit-style technology.

Well, I've given him what he wants. His X9i now tells me that its time to phone up a friend and fix dinner plans. But first let me do a little browsing on my laptop after I get home. For now, I'm going to relax to some music on my iPod Touch. So was I without technology? Was I Disconnected? Hah! ■

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